

polish that modern gamers are used to. As we've mentioned above, there are a ton of games that have mid-sized budg-

ets that force developers to really think out of the box, but these experiences are few and far between. One can only

hope. Until then, I'll be mashing my PS2 controller trying to beat Godhand at the hardest difficulty. Wish me luck! *

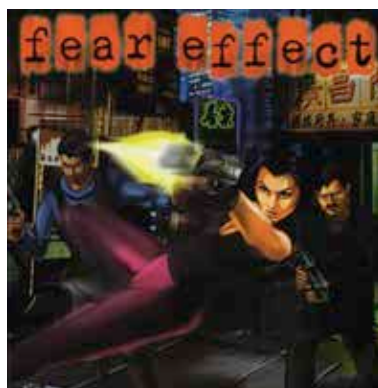
A few Double-A games that are still worth sinking a bit of time into

Godhand: PS2

Developed by the geniuses at Clover Studio, Godhand was a brawler like no other. Imagine games like Final Fight and Street of Rage but with a third-person perspective and the most varied and customisable moves list this side of the Atlantic. The game has a silly tone and was



not the most polished experience out there but the crushing combat and adjusting difficulty makes this a gem in the rough. You can chain multiple combos together, if only you pay attention to what you're doing. It's intense, crazy and most importantly an incredibly fun game. If you like fast-paced brawlers, you'll love Godhand.

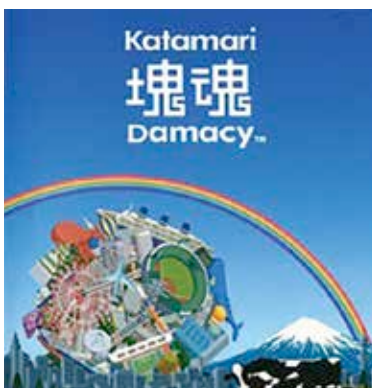


Fear Effect: PS1

Fear Effect was essentially an RE (Resident Evil) clone but it had its own unique sense of style and art direction. Sure, you get the basic pre-rendered backgrounds and the tight camera angles, but Fear Effect had a cool cell-shaded look to all its characters. This made them instantly recognizable and really added some colour and style to the proceedings. The game is very similar to Re as in it's a third-person shooter but it has a unique mechanic of a health bar that's replaced by a Fear Meter. The more scared you are, the faster you'll lose health. The game had you play as three different protagonists, each with a distinct storyline and game-play. If you're an RE fan, you should check out Fear Effect and its sequel.

Katamari Damacy: PS2

One of the more unique games to have emerged from the Double-A era, Katamari Damacy sees you take the form of an adhesive ball picking up things wherever it rolls. It's a strange but surprisingly addictive game that really shows off the creativity and imagination of its develop-



ers. The game's plot concerns a diminutive prince, who's on a mission to rebuild the stars, constellations, and Moon, which were accidentally destroyed by his father, the King of All Cosmos. Yeah, it's a little strange but stick with it and you'll be rewarded with a unique and incredibly fun experience.

Hellblade: Senua's Sacrifice: PS4, Xbox, PC

While I'm not a big fan of walking simulators, there are people who enjoy them. Hellblade is one of those games. There isn't much action and it really serves as a crude metaphor for mental illness but as far as budgets go, Senua's Sacrifice is a Double-A game. The game follows a Pict woman called Senua as she traverses the dark lands to free her lover from the clutches of Hela. The graphics look great but for someone like me who prefers an actual game, Hellblade really did not hit the spot. But, if you're into walking simulators with a message then you might enjoy the experience. On the other hand, if you like unique games that really push the envelope, you'd be better served looking elsewhere.

